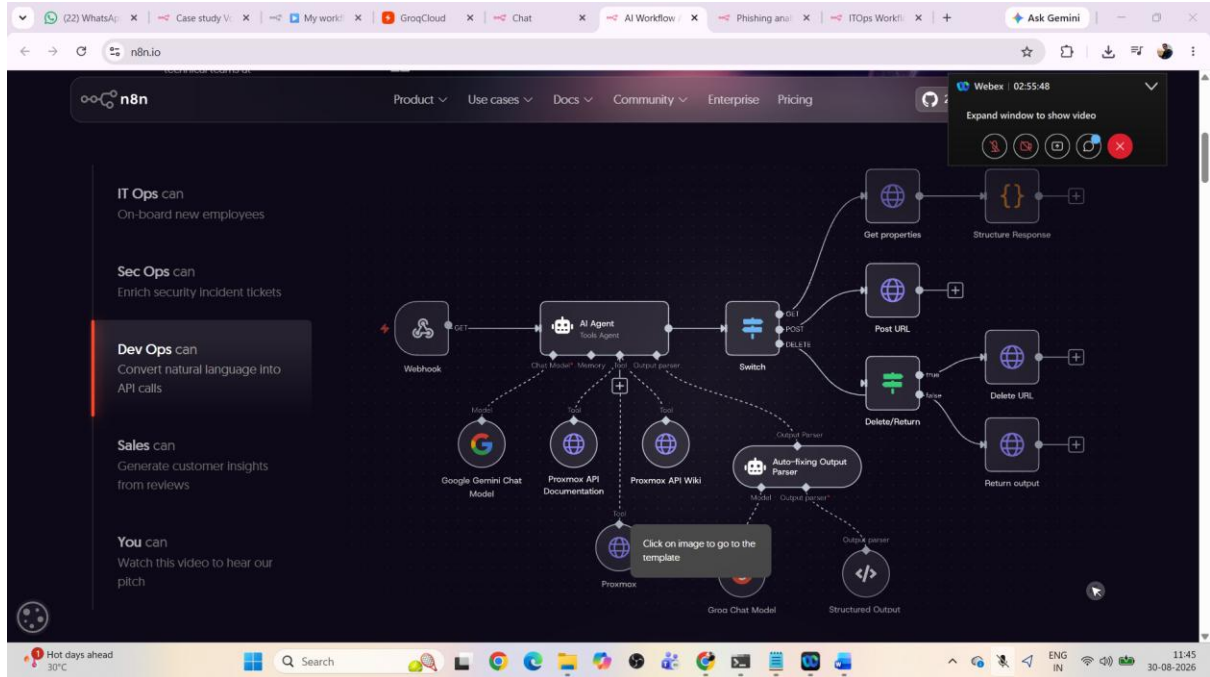
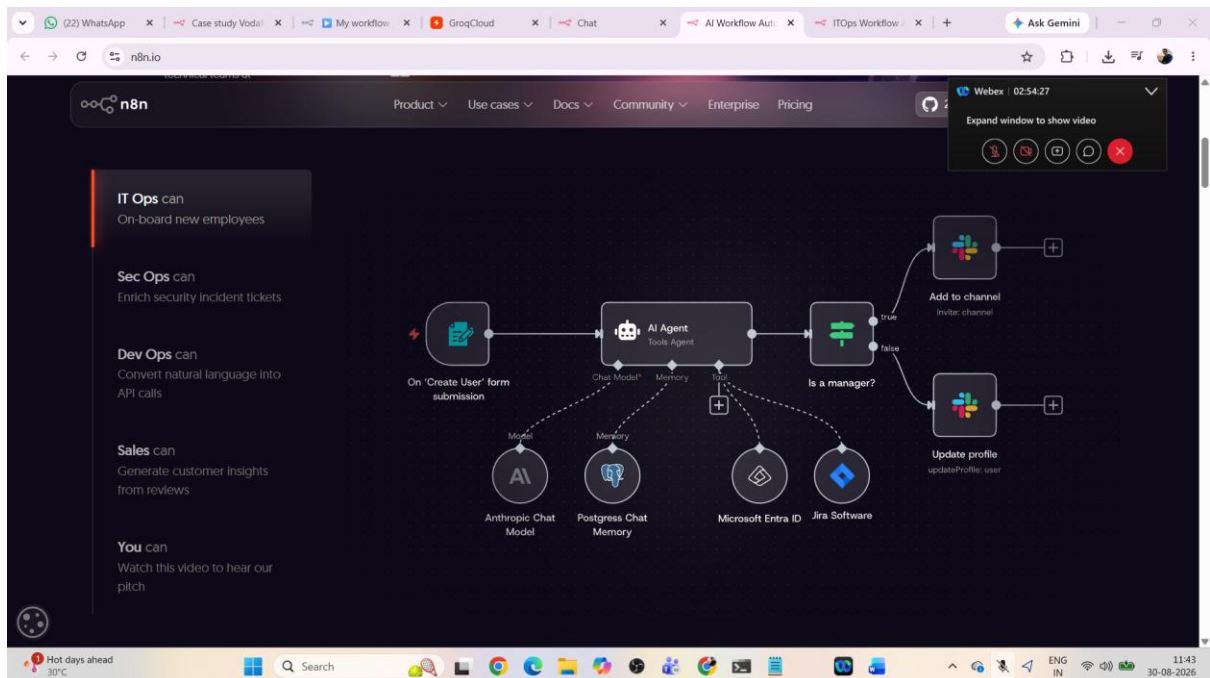
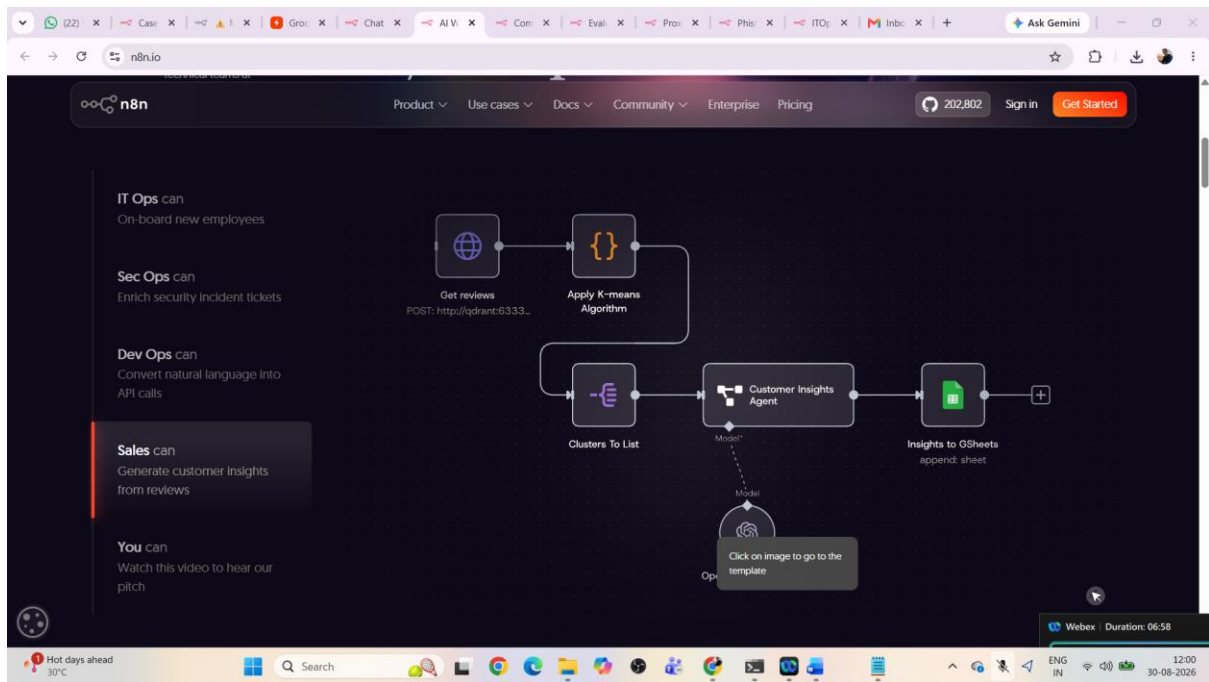






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Execute workflow

Logs

Nothing to display yet. Execute the workflow to see execution logs.

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Workflow diagram showing steps: When clicking "Execute Workflow", Fetch Essay List, Extract essay names, Split out into items, List to first 3, Fetch essay texts, Summarize them with GPT, Extract Text Only, Summarization Chain, Merge contents.

Execute workflow

Logs

Success in 16.7s24,788 Tokens

INPUT

titleHow to Do Great Work

response

textA practical guide to doing great work: pick projects where aptitude and deep interest overlap, learn to the frontier, spot gaps, and explore promising ones. Start by doing—especially your own projects—iterate from prototypes, finish what you start, and sustain long, focused effort: small daily progress compounds into breakthroughs. Cultivate intense curiosity, strange tastes, and willingness to break conventions (for he innocent of them) while learning rigorous standards. I like to keep

OUTPUT

summary

A practical guide to doing great work: pick projects where aptitude and deep interest overlap, learn to the frontier, spot gaps, and explore promising

url

http://www.paulgraham.com/greatwork.htm

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HOW TO DO GREAT WORK

July 2023

If you collected lists of techniques for doing great work in a lot of different fields, what would the intersection look like? I decided to find out by making it.

Partly my goal was to create a guide that could be used by someone working in any field. But I was also curious about the shape of the intersection. And one thing this exercise shows is that it does have a definite shape; it's not just a point labelled "work hard."

The following recipe assumes you're very ambitious.

The first step is to decide what to work on. The work you choose needs to have three qualities: it has to be something you have a natural aptitude for, that you have a deep interest in, and that offers scope to do great work.

In practice you don't have to worry much about the third criterion. Ambitious people are if anything already too conservative about it. So all you need to do is find something you have an aptitude for and great interest in. [↗](#)

That sounds straightforward, but it's often quite difficult. When you're young you don't know what you're good at or what different kinds of work are like. Some kinds of work you end up doing may not even exist yet. So while some people know what they want to do at 14, most have to figure it out.

The way to figure out what to work on is by working. If you're not sure what to work on, guess. But pick something and get going. You'll probably guess wrong some of the time, but that's fine. It's good to know about multiple things; some of the biggest discoveries come from noticing connections between different fields.

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ON LISP

On Lisp is a comprehensive study of advanced Lisp techniques, with bottom-up programming as the unifying theme. It gives the first complete description of macros and macro applications. The book also covers important subjects related to bottom-up programming, including functional programming, rapid prototyping, interactive development, and embedded languages. The final chapter takes a deeper look at object-oriented programming than previous Lisp books, showing the step-by-step construction of a working model of the Common Lisp Object System (CLOS).

As well as an indispensable reference, *On Lisp* is a source of software. Its examples form a library of functions and macros that readers will be able to use in their own Lisp programs.

Prentice Hall, 1993, 432 pages, paperback. ISBN 0130305529.

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QUOTES FROM REVIEWERS

"The first book that really explains what Lisp is all about."

- John Foderaro, Franz Inc.

"*On Lisp* draws the reader in from the very first sentence. The author's writing style is clear and articulate, but comfortably informal. The subject matter is important, and has not been adequately treated in previous books. The chapters on macros present important material that is virtually unique to this book.

The chapter on object-oriented programming is excellent. The author builds a nice mini-CLOS to teach basic object-oriented techniques, but then wisely switches to real CLOS to cover the more advanced topics."

- David Touretzky, Carnegie-Mellon University

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